

soil, it is true, but yet of Israelitism itself.* Thus the most that can be assumed is, that the Parsee worship hastened the development of the seed which already existed, or, in other words, that Ezra and the Sopherîm were the more ready to transplant the synagogue to the soil of Judæa, because such a worship as was practised there was also in use among the Persians, and was evidently a powerful means of cultivating religious feeling among the people. Interpreted in this way, the influence of Parseeism can be recognized, not only in the organization of the synagogue, but also in the whole priestly legislation, in the redaction of which Ezra, as our previous investigations show, took an active part. The precepts concerning *clean* and *unclean*, which occupy so large a space in it,† are of Israelitish origin.‡ But intercourse with a people such as the Persians, who possessed similar regulations and made their faithful observance a point of honour, may have contributed to cause the priestly traditions to be carefully written down, and, after they were committed to writing, to make them find acceptance with the Jewish nation.

Be this as it may, it can in no case surprise us that here and there elements of Parseeism were adopted by the Jews, or at all events by their spiritual leaders. There was no actual introduction of Parsee ideas or ceremonies. But more than one originally Parsee notion was first embraced by a few, then applauded by many, to be gradually naturalized at last in Judaism. If we examine more closely under what circumstances and how this occurred, we find that during and after the exile wants arose in Israel which Parseeism met, as it were. The Jewish religion develops itself independently and on its own ground in a certain direction. In consequence of this, voids make themselves felt in the traditional ideas. Where this is found to be the case, but only there, what is wanting in Judaism, and yet seems as if it ought not to be wanting, is borrowed from Parseeism. If I be not mistaken, the exami-

* Above, pp. 17, sq. † Vol. II. pp. 259, sq. ‡ Vol. II. pp. 31, sq., 94-96.